

Ochorus — Backlinks & Site-Rank Growth Strategy

A tailored plan to earn authority and climb the rankings · 2026-09-18 · 2-page brief

The thesis. Ochorus is not a thin site that needs technical SEO work — the on-site layer is already mature (sitemap index + full hreflang + image sitemaps, comprehensive prerendering with a 6-hourly CI audit, wide JSON-LD, 5 live languages, **90/92 author bios+FAQ**, and a content-generation skill suite built as an SEO lever). So the real frontier is two things we *haven't* done: **(a) flip a few switches that aren't on yet**, and **(b) go earn off-site authority** — genuinely greenfield. Our unfair advantage: **the library IS the linkable asset** — we host the actual full-text classics that scholars, pastors, bloggers and Wikipedia editors are already looking for. The job is to be found and cited, not to invent link bait. Backlinks remain a top-3 Google ranking factor in 2026, but must be *earned*, *not bought*.

THE TOP 20 WAYS

TIER 1 · ON-SITE SWITCHES TO FLIP FIRST — HIGHEST ROI, LOW EFFORT	
1	Turn on analytics + fully verify Search Console. Set PUBLIC_PLAUSIBLE_DOMAIN; verify GSC + Bing; submit sitemap; add IndexNow. <i>We're flying blind without impression data.</i> FLIP
2	Mine GSC for "striking-distance" queries (positions 5–20) and improve those exact pages — fastest rank lift, no links needed. FLIP → MAKE
3	Selectively re-advertise best chapter/scripture pages (~1,890 currently un-advertised; reversible in one filter). FLIP
4	Deepen internal linking into pillar → cluster topics — a dense link graph on a subject beats one long page. MAKE
5	Close the multilingual depth gap on already-ranking works — each translation is a new page in a less-competitive market. MAKE
TIER 2 · NICHE BACKLINK GOLDMINES — THE UNFAIR ADVANTAGES	
6	Wikipedia & Wikisource citations — highest-authority, most on-topic source; maps 1:1 to our catalog. Contribute as a real editor, never spam. EARN
7	Church / seminary / ministry .edu & .org links — high-trust resource lists. EARN
8	Resource-page outreach — "free Christian classics" lists; our multilingual reader is the differentiator. EARN
9	Broken-link reclamation — offer our live page for dead copies of texts we host (highest conversion). EARN
10	Curated directory / aggregator listings — real directories only, no farms. EARN
TIER 3 · DIGITAL PR — THE COMPOUNDING ENGINE	
11	Journalist-request stack — Source of Sources (free), Qwoted, Featured; reply within the hour. EARN
12	Original data as link bait — "most-read classics by language/country"; publish + pitch. MAKE → EARN
13	Founder guest essays + podcasts in Christian-media / open-knowledge outlets. EARN
14	Unlinked-mention reclamation — alert on "Ochorus", ask for the link. EARN
TIER 4 · CONTENT AS CITABLE ASSET — LEANS ON EXISTING SKILLS	
15	Scale the Articles layer as topical hubs (write-article), aimed at real search demand. MAKE
16	Deepen author bios + Q&A for E-E-A-T (write-biography, sermon-questions). MAKE
17	Quote pages as micro-linkable assets — shareable, schema'd, OG cards (quote-extraction). MAKE
18	AEO/GEO — get cited by ChatGPT / Perplexity / Google AI; our clean HTML + schema already help. MAKE/FLIP
TIER 5 · DISTRIBUTION & DISCOVERY	
19	Community seeding on high-crawl domains (relevant subreddits, forums, Goodreads) — seeds fast indexing. EARN
20	Owned channels + share loops — newsletter, quote cards, share buttons on OG cards. MAKE
Bet hardest on #6 (Wikipedia/Wikisource) and #11 (digital PR) — both high-authority, directly on-topic, and play to what Ochorus uniquely has.	

THE 90-DAY PLAN

WINDOW	FOCUS	MOVES
Weeks 1–2	Instrument & flip	Plausible on + CSP; verify GSC/Bing; submit sitemap + IndexNow; baseline impressions, indexed-vs-submitted, referring domains, top queries. Items 1–2.
Weeks 3–6	On-site lift + goldmine outreach	Fix striking-distance pages; build 1–2 full topic clusters as the template; start Wikipedia/Wikisource for top-20 authors; first resource-page + broken-link batch; next article wave. Items 4, 6, 8, 9, 15.
Weeks 7–10	Digital PR engine on	Join Source of Sources / Qwoted / Featured, answer daily; mention alerts + reclamation; first guest/podcast outreach; genuine community participation. Items 11, 13, 14, 19.
Weeks 11–13	Linkable assets + measure	Publish + pitch first original-data piece; grow quote pages + share loop; re-advertise earned chapters; prioritize translations & author-page depth by impressions; tune AEO/GEO. Items 12, 17, 20 → 3, 5, 16, 18.
Ongoing	Every quarter	Re-rank targets by real impressions; keep the article/translation/quote flywheel turning; work the PR stack; ship one new linkable-asset per quarter.

HOW WE MEASURE

- **Referring domains** (the real backlink KPI — domains, not raw links) + their quality/relevance.
- **Organic impressions & clicks** (GSC), overall + per content type + per locale.
- **Indexed vs. submitted** per sitemap section (already split for exactly this).
- **Keyword positions** — count of queries in positions 1–3 / 4–10.
- **AI-referral traffic** — citations from answer engines.
- **Outreach funnel** — prospects → contacted → links won, per tactic.

Set numeric targets only *after* week-2 baseline exists. Tools are mostly free: GSC, Bing, Plausible + a backlink checker.

WHAT NOT TO DO

- **No bought links, PBNs, link farms, or directory blasts.** One relevant high-authority link beats dozens of weak ones; manipulative links risk a penalty.
- **No Wikipedia / Wikisource / Reddit spam.** Only works as a genuine contributor; spam gets reverted and can blacklist the domain.
- **No thin auto-translated pages** to inflate page count — exactly why locales stay gated until "go live". Depth over count.
- **No keyword-stuffing or AI filler.** Google's Helpful Content system targets it; ship review-gated, genuinely useful pages.

FIRST FIVE MOVES — START TODAY

- 1

Set **PUBLIC_PLAUSIBLE_DOMAIN** + confirm **GSC verification** — get data flowing. *Everything else is guesswork without it.*
- 2

Build the **Wikipedia/Wikisource target list** for the top-20 authors and start contributing legitimately.
- 3

Build the **resource-page + broken-link prospect list** for "free Christian classics".
- 4

Sign up for **Source of Sources** (free) and start answering relevant journalist requests.
- 5

Build one topic into a complete **pillar → cluster** as the repeatable template.

Research (2026): Semrush & Link-Assistant (link building — earned not bought, digital PR, resource/broken-link, unlinked mentions) · Knapsack & Digital Applied (topical authority, pillar+cluster, E-E-A-T) · Barchart & BuzzStream (HARO successors: Source of Sources, Qwoted, Featured) · Digital Applied & ai-glot (international/hreflang SEO) · DEV & Index Machine (indexing, AI crawlers need server-rendered HTML) · Wikisource/Wikipedia (free public-domain text library + citation norms). Full URLs in docs/seo-backlinks-strategy.md.